

Lesson 26: Impersonal Constructions in IT

Introduction to Impersonal Constructions

"Hello everyone. In today's lesson, we're going to explore some impersonal constructions often used in the IT industry, specifically 'it is said that...', 'he is said to...', 'he is supposed to...', and 'have something done.' These constructions are useful for discussing actions or responsibilities without directly naming the doer, which can be particularly helpful in a professional context.

'It is said that...' is used to convey what is generally believed or reported by people. For example, 'It is said that the new software can reduce processing time significantly.'

'He is said to...' talks about what someone is generally believed to do or be capable of doing. For instance, 'He is said to be an expert in cybersecurity.'

'He is supposed to...' is used to talk about expected actions or duties. For example, 'He is supposed to update the network security protocols.'

'Have something done' implies getting someone else to do something for you. For instance, 'We will have the server maintained by a specialist.'

In the IT field, where conveying information accurately and tactfully is important, how do you usually talk about general beliefs, expectations, or outsourcing tasks?"

Different Ways to Use Impersonal Constructions in IT

"Using 'It Is Said That...' for General Beliefs:

****For Conveying Reports or Beliefs**:** 'It is said that the new update will greatly improve system efficiency.' It shares a general belief or report.

Using 'He Is Said To...' for Individual Capabilities or Actions:

****For Describing Someone's Reputation or Skills**:** 'He is said to have extensive experience in software development.' It speaks about a person's capabilities based on general belief.

Using 'He Is Supposed To...' for Expected Actions:

****For Talking About Duties or Responsibilities**:** 'He is supposed to lead the next project meeting.' It mentions what someone is expected to do.

Using 'Have Something Done' for Outsourced Actions:

****For Actions Done by Others**:** 'We have the system checked regularly by an external auditor.' It shows that the action is done by someone else.

In your IT work, how often do you use these constructions? Do they help you in discussing tasks, responsibilities, or team capabilities?"

Dialogue between IT Professionals

"Let's follow a dialogue between two IT professionals, David and Lisa, using these impersonal constructions:

****David**:** *Lisa, it is said that the new database system will greatly enhance data retrieval speed. Have you heard about it?*

****Lisa**:** *Yes, I have. The new system is said to be very efficient.*

****David**:** *Also, our team leader, John, is supposed to announce the implementation plan today.*

*****Lisa**:** Right. John is said to be very knowledgeable about database migration.*

*****David**:** By the way, have we had the security audit done for the current system?*

*****Lisa**:** Yes, we had it done last week by a third-party company. The report is said to be ready by tomorrow.*

*****David**:** Great. It's important we have these checks done regularly.*

*****Lisa**:** Absolutely. Staying updated on security is crucial.*

This conversation demonstrates how David and Lisa use 'it is said that...', 'he is said to...', 'he is supposed to...', and 'have something done' to discuss general beliefs, individual responsibilities, and outsourced tasks in their IT work."

'It Is Said That...' in IT Discussions

"When discussing upcoming trends or technologies in IT, 'it is said that...' can be particularly useful. For instance, 'It is said that quantum computing will revolutionize data encryption.'

Think about your discussions on IT advancements. How do you use 'it is said that...' to introduce information based on general reports or beliefs?"

'He Is Said To...' in Evaluating IT Professionals

"In evaluating or discussing the capabilities of IT professionals, 'he is said to...' is often used. 'He is said to be an expert in AI programming.' It conveys what is commonly believed about someone's skills or experience.

How do you use 'he is said to...' in talking about your colleagues or other professionals in your field? Does it help in providing a sense of their reputation or skills?"

'He Is Supposed To...' for Role Expectations

"When talking about expectations or responsibilities in IT roles, 'he is supposed to...' is commonly used. For instance, 'He is supposed to deliver the project update in today's meeting.' It sets out the expected actions or duties of a person.

Consider your team or projects. How do you use 'he is supposed to...' to talk about roles and responsibilities?"

'Have Something Done' in IT Outsourcing

"In situations where tasks are outsourced or delegated in IT, 'have something done' is an effective way to

describe this. 'We have our network security tested annually by a specialized firm.' It shows that the action is carried out by someone else, not by the speaker or the team.

Reflect on your experience with outsourcing or delegating tasks. How does 'have something done' help in describing actions taken by external parties?"

The Use of 'It Is Said That...' in IT Rumors and Reports

"Think about the times when you've heard rumors or reports about upcoming technologies or company changes in IT. How often do you use 'It is said that...' in such contexts? This phrase is useful for sharing information that is widely believed or reported, without committing to its accuracy. For example, you might say, 'It is said that our company is going to invest heavily in blockchain technology.' This form allows you to convey the information while maintaining a neutral stance.

How do you ensure that using 'It is said that...' communicates the speculative nature of the information you are sharing? Do you find it helps in initiating discussions on topics based on hearsay or unconfirmed reports?"

'He Is Said To...' in Discussing Colleagues' Skills or Achievements

"In professional IT environments, discussing colleagues' skills or achievements often requires a delicate balance. 'He is said to...' allows you to acknowledge someone's capabilities or accomplishments based on general belief without making direct assertions. For instance, 'He is said to have developed a groundbreaking algorithm.'

Reflect on your interactions with colleagues. How do you use 'He is said to...' to discuss their abilities or achievements? Does it help in maintaining professionalism while acknowledging their contributions?"

The Implications of 'He Is Supposed To...' in IT Responsibilities

"Consider how you talk about expectations and responsibilities in your IT team. The phrase 'He is supposed to...' is often used to refer to tasks or roles that are expected of someone. For example, 'He is supposed to update the cybersecurity measures by the end of this month.' It sets an expectation or a standard for a particular task.

How does using 'He is supposed to...' affect the way responsibilities are communicated in your team? Do you find it effective in clarifying expected actions or roles?"

The Practicality of 'Have Something Done' in IT Delegation

"Delegation is a key aspect of IT management. How do you communicate tasks or responsibilities that you assign to others? 'Have something done' is particularly useful in such situations. Saying 'We will have the server maintenance done by an external vendor' clearly indicates that the task will be carried out by someone else, not by your team directly.

How often do you use 'Have something done' in your professional communications? Does it help in clearly indicating outsourced tasks or delegated responsibilities?"

Personal Experience: A Lesson on Impersonal Constructions

"As an online English teacher specializing in IT professionals, I recall a student who was drafting a report on a failed project. He was unsure how to describe the speculated reasons for the failure without placing direct blame. We explored using 'It is said that...' and 'He is supposed to...' to discuss these sensitive aspects. 'It is said that there were unforeseen technical challenges' and 'The project manager was supposed to ensure timely completion' allowed him to address the issues impersonally.

Have you faced similar challenges in reporting sensitive information? How did you navigate this while maintaining professionalism?"

'It Is Said That...' in Preparing for Industry Changes

"In the fast-paced IT industry, staying ahead of trends and changes is crucial. When preparing for these changes, 'It is said that...' can be a valuable tool for discussing anticipated developments. 'It is said that artificial intelligence will play a major role in future software development.'

How do you use 'It is said that...' to prepare for and adapt to industry changes? Does it help in framing discussions about future directions or trends?"

'He Is Said To...' in Employee Evaluations

"In employee evaluations or when considering candidates for a project, 'He is said to...' allows you to reference someone's abilities or reputation in a way that is based on general opinion. 'He is said to be proficient in multiple programming languages.'

How do you balance using 'He is said to...' with direct observations in evaluations? Does it assist in providing a well-rounded view of an individual's capabilities?"

The Effectiveness of 'Have Something Done' in IT Outsourcing

"In IT, outsourcing certain tasks can be more efficient. When discussing such decisions, 'Have something done' is useful. For instance, 'We will have the user interface designed by a specialized company.' It clarifies that the task will be handled externally.

Consider your outsourcing decisions. How does 'Have something done' help in communicating these choices clearly and effectively?"

Enhancing Communication Skills with Impersonal Constructions

"In IT, where communication needs to be clear yet tactful, especially when dealing with speculative information or sensitive topics, mastering impersonal constructions is invaluable. Whether it's discussing rumors with 'It is said that...', acknowledging skills with 'He is said to...', setting expectations with 'He is supposed to...', or indicating delegation with 'Have something done', these forms are essential in your communication toolkit.

How do you plan to use these impersonal constructions in your professional communication? Are there specific IT scenarios where you find one form more effective than the others?"

Applying Impersonal Constructions in Professional IT Scenarios

"Applying these impersonal constructions in professional IT scenarios is essential for effective communication. Whether you're discussing potential industry changes, evaluating team members, setting task expectations, or indicating outsourced responsibilities, using 'It is said that...', 'He is said to...', 'He is supposed to...', and 'Have something done' can significantly enhance the clarity and professionalism of your communication.

In your day-to-day IT tasks, how will you apply what you've learned about these constructions? How can they enhance your ability to communicate effectively in various professional contexts?"
